

Professor Spencer J Williams

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31 Jan 2024

Re: Letter of recommendation for Artur Nastasovici

To whom it may concern

I write to offer my strong support for Artur Nastasovici, a motivated, promising young scientist.

Artur undertook a 12-month internship in my laboratory in Feb 2023-Feb 2024. My laboratory specializes in synthetic organic chemistry, microbiology, and biochemistry. Artur worked under the supervision of a postdoctoral researcher, Dr Laura Burchill, as well as myself.

Artur was involved in a project that developed Artur's skills in microbiology and biochemistry. He developed excellent practical skills in basic microbiological techniques including sterile culture, subculturing, collecting bacteria from liquid culture, and measuring growth curves and sampling bacteria across a growth curve. Artur also spent considerable time conducting biochemical assays, mainly using a UV/vis spectrophotometer, and became proficient in accurate liquid handling, preparing samples and acquiring real-time kinetic data. Artur developed confidence in basic laboratory maintenance tasks including safe operating procedures, preparation of microbiological media and buffers, as well as safe handling and disposal of biological materials and low-level chemical wastes.

Artur's internship required the preparation of various written reports for external assessment by his home institution, and as part of this he prepared a report summarizing key techniques he learnt. While Artur was not required to lead a project and design experiments, he started to develop some of these basic skills and with further support I could see he could become more proficient in project planning, especially if this were combined with more training in theory.

Artur was highly congenial and was a valuable team member who fit well with our team, and I am not aware of any conflicts with other team members. He was very hard working, reliable and punctual, and regularly sought feedback to ensure that he was performing his work to the required standard. As Artur's technical training lacked much depth of theory, he entered the project at a very low level of understanding, however, it is clear that he exhibited a genuine interest in the projects in which he was involved.

Overall, I was impressed by Artur's enthusiasm, energy, and clear desire to generate high quality data, while also being a harmonious contributor to the team. The work that he contributed to is to be published, and I expect that Artur will be a co-author of at least 2 scientific publications.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read "Spencer Williams".

Professor Spencer J. Williams